Section 1: Foundational Concepts of Analytics

1. Business Analytics

Definition: business analytics is when companies use information and numbers to help them make better choices. It helps them know what is working and what needs to change.

Example: a supermarket checks which snacks sell the most every month so they can order more of them.

Source: Investopedia

2. Data Analytics

Definition: data analytics means looking at raw information to understand patterns and useful facts. It helps people learn from the data they collect.

Example: a bank studies spending patterns to notice strange payments

Source: IBM

3. Business Intelligence (BI)

Definition: business intelligence is when businesses use tools like charts and dashboards to understand their data. It makes it easier to see how the company is doing

Example: a shop manager uses a dashboard to see weekly sales.

Source: Microsoft Power BI

4. Data-Driven Decision Making

Definition: this means making choices using facts and numbers instead of guessing. It helps businesses make smarter decisions.

Example: a restuarant checks customer reviews before changing the menu.

Source: Harvard Business Review

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5. Big Data

Definition: big data is a huge amount of information collected every day. normal systems may struggle to handle it because it is so large and fast-growing.

Example: social media apps collect millions of likes, videos and comments daily

Source: Oracle

6. Descriptive Analytics

Definition: descriptive analytics looks at old data to explain what already happened. It helps people understand past results and often shown in reports.

Example: a business checks last year's profit and losses

Source: SAS

7. Diagnostic Analytics

Definition: diagnostic analytics tries to find out why something happened. It compares data to look for reasons or causes and helps solve problems.

Example: A clothing shop checks why winter sales went down.

Source: IBM

8. Predictive Analytics

Definition: predictive analytics uses past information to guess what may happen next. Helps businesses prepare for the future. Is based on trends and patterns

Example: a store predicts more jacket sales before winter starts

Source: SAP

9. Prescriptive Analytics

Definition: prescriptive analytics suggests the best action to take after studying data. Helps businesses know what to do next, it helps save time and money

Example: a delivery company uses software to choose the fastest route.

Source: IBM

10. Data Literacy

Definition: data literacy means being able to read and understand information shown in graphs or tables. Means using data correctly and is an important skill today also.

Example: A manager uses graphs to improve worker performance

Source: Tableau

Section 2: Data, Measurement & Reporting

11. Structured data

Definition: Structured data is information that is neatly organized in rows and columns. It is easy to store, search and understand. kept in spreadsheets or databases.

Example: a class list with learner names, ages, and marks in a table

Source: IBM

12. Unstructured data

Definition: unstructured data is information that is not organized in a fixed way. It can be things like messages, pictures, videos or voice notes. this type of data is hard to sort.

Example: Comments people post on social media about a new shoe brand.

Source: Oracle

13. Data Warehouse

Definition: a data warehouse is a big storage place where companies keep data from many places together. Helps businesses look at old information easily. is useful for reports and planning.

Example: a retail store keeps sales data from all branches in one system.

Source: Microsoft Azure

14. Data Mining

Definition: data mining means searching through lots of data to find hidden patterns or useful facts. It helps businesses understand customer behavior and improve decisions.

Example: a supermarket notices that people often buy bread and milk together

Source: SAS

15. Data Visualization

Definition: data visualization means showing data using graphs, charts, or pictures. This makes the information easier to understand quickly.

Example: a bar chart showing monthly sales growth

Source: Tableau

16. Dashboard.

Definition: a dashboard is a screen that shows important business information in one place. Helps people check progress quickly. many businesses use dashboards every day

Example: a manager checks daily sales and customer numbers on one screen.

Source: Microsoft Power BI

17. Metric

Definition: a metric is something that can be measured to track progress or performance. Businesses use metrics to see how well they are doing. numbers make it easier to compare results.

Example: the number of website visitors in one week.

Source: HubSpot

18. Key Performance Indicator (KPI)

Definition: a KPI is an important metric linked to a business goal. It helps show if the business is succesful or not.

Example: reaching a monthly sales target

Source: Investopedia

19. Benchmark:

Definition: a benchmark is a standard used to compare performance. It helps a business know if it is doing better or worse than others. It can show where improvement is needed.

Example: comparing your shop's sales to other shops in the same area

Source: indeed business glossary.

20. Segmentation

Definition: segmentation means dividing customers into groups with similar interests or ages. Different groups often need different products.

Example: a clothing store advertises teens' fashion to teenagers and formal wear to adults.

Source: HubSpot

Section 3: Customer & Sales KPIs

21. Conversion Rate

Definition: conversion rate is the percentage of people who do what a business wants them to do. this could be buying something, signing up, or downloading an app.

Example: if 100 people visit a website and 10 buy shoes, the conversion rate is 10%.

Source: Hubspot

22. Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

Definition: customer acquisition cost is how much money a business spends to get one new customer. this includes adverts and marketing costs.

Example: a company spends R5000 on ads and gets 50 new customers, so CAC is R100 each

Source: Investopedia

23. Customer Lifetime Value (CLV/LTV)

Definition: customer lifetime value is how much money one customer may spend over along time. it shows how valuable loyal customers are.

Example: a customer buys groceries every month for three years

Source: Shopify

24. Churn Rate

Definition: churn rate is the percentage of customers who stop using a service. a high churn rate can be a warning sign. it may mean customers are unhappy.

Example: a streaming app loses 20 out of 500 users in one month.

Source: Zendesk

25. Customer Retention Rate

Definition: customer retention rate shows how many customers stay with a business over time. it is the opposite of churn rate. a high rate is usually a good sign.

Example: A gym keeps 90% of its members for the whole year

Source: Hubspot

26. Net Promoter Score (NPS)

Definition: net promoter score measures if customers would recommend a business to others. happy customers usually give higher scores. It shows customer loyalty.

Example: a hotel asks guests to rate their stay from 1 to 10.

Source: Qualtrics

27. Average Order Value (AOV)

Definition: average order value is the average amount customers spend each time they buy. it helps businesses understand spending habits. Higher AOV can mean more profit.

Example: if sales are R10 000 from 100 orders, the AOV is R100

Source: Shopify

28. Sales Funnel

Definition: a sales funnel shows the steps custumers take before buying something. It starts when they first hear about the product. it helps businesses see where customers lose interest.

Example: a person sees an ad, visits the website, adds shoes to cart, then buys them.

Source: Salesforce.

Section 4: Marketing & Campaign Analytics

29. Marketing Campaign

Definition: a marketing campaign is a plan to promote a product or business. It can use social media, posters, TV or emails. The goal is to attract customers.

Example: a clothing store runs a back-to-school sale on Instagram.

Source: HubSpot

30. Post-Campaign Analysis

Definition: post-campaign analysis means checking results after a campaign ends. It helps businesses learn what worked well and what did not. This helps improve future campaigns.

Example: a company checks sales after a Black Friday sale

Source: Google Analytics Help

31. Incremental Revenue

Definition: Incremental revenue is extra money made because of a promotion or action. It shows the added benefit of the campaign. businesses compare it to normal income

Example: a store usually makes R20 000 but makes R28 000 during a sale, so extra revenue is R8000

Source: Investopedia

32. Return on Investment (ROI)

Definition: ROI measures how much profit was made compared to money spent. It helps businesses know if something was worth the cost.

Example: a company spends R5000 and earns R10 000 profit.

Source: Investopedia

33. Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)

Definition: ROAS shows how much money is earned from adverts. It only focuses on advertising results. It helps businesses judge ad access.

Example: R1000 spent on ads brings in R4000 sales, so ROAS is 4:1

Source: Google Ads Help

34. Click-Through Rate (CTR)

Definition: click-through rate is the percentage of people who click on a advert or link. It shows if the advert catches attention.

Example: If 1000 people see an ad and 50 click it, the CTR is 5%.

Source: Google Ads Help

35. Bounce Rate.

Definition: bounce rate is the percentage of people who leave a website after viewing one page only. It can mean the page was not interesting enough.

Example: someone opens a homepage and leaves straight away

Source: Google Analytics Help

36. A/B Testing

Definition: A/B testing compares two versions of something to see which works better. businesses use it to improve adverts, websites, or emails. It helps make better

Example: A store tests two advert pictures to see which gets more clicks

Source: HubSpot

37. Lead Generation

Definition: Lead generation means finding people who may become future customers. businesses collect contact details to follow up later.

Example: a company offers a free ebook for an email address

Source: Salesforce

38. Marketing Attribution

Definition: marketing attribution means finding out which advert or channel helped make a sale. It helps businesses know where customers came from.

Example: a customer sees a Facebook ad, then searches on Google, then buys online.

Source: HubSpot